

Papai Relaxed on Hill and in Lobby

By LESTER KOELLING
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MINNEAPOLIS—Thirty minutes after the last out was made in Omaha last night,



Koelling

Pitcher Al Papai was working a crossword puzzle in the hotel lobby.

There wasn't the slightest suspicion, nor any outward indication, that he was the fellow who just 30 minutes before had completed nine innings of pitching in a tense 4-3 Indianapolis victory.

He was slumped in a chair, the picture of ease and contentment. The pen in his hand moved rapidly as he filled in one word after another. He wasn't even conscious of the small group that stood around him.

TRIBE BOX SCORE

INDIANAPOLIS (4)

	*B.	Avg.	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E
Beard, cf.....	.337	3	1	3	2	4	0	0	0
Garcia, 2b.....	.297	4	0	1	1	0	8	1	
Jackson, 1b.....	.338	4	0	0	1	14	1	0	
Delsing, rf.....	.273	4	0	0	1	1	0	1	
Christley, lf.....	.000	4	0	0	0	2	0	1	
Romano, c.....	.317	4	0	0	0	3	0	0	
Prokechich, ss.....	.196	3	0	0	1	2	2	1	
Williams, 3b.....	.265	3	0	0	0	0	2	0	
Papai, p.....	.285	3	0	0	0	1	2	0	

*At start of game.

OMAHA (3)

	*B.	Avg.	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E
Diering, cf.....	.294	4	0	1	1	3	0	0	
Smith, 2b.....	.250	4	0	0	2	0	3	0	
Gerbaux, rf.....	.300	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	
Pless, 3b.....	.429	4	0	1	1	0	4	1	
King, lf.....	.143	3	1	0	1	2	1	0	
Brown, c.....	.270	4	0	1	1	9	1	0	
Limmer, 1b.....	.229	4	0	0	0	12	0	0	
Durnbaugh, ss.....	.212	2	0	0	1	1	0	0	
aCommand.....	.234	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	
Dixon, ss.....	.289	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	
Moford, p.....	.000	2	0	0	0	0	3	0	
Blasettter.....	.333	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	
Schultz, p.....	.000	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
cBarnes.....	.000	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	

*At start of game.

aGrounded out for Durnbaugh in 4th.

"Nice game, Al," someone volunteered.

"Thanks," came back the reply.

"You looked strong in those last two innings," the visitor pried.

"Felt good all the way," came back the soft response, and then a question: "What's a three-letter word for a river in England that ends in AM?"

"So you weren't worried?" That question was put to him by Manager Andy Cohen.

"Wouldn't say that," Al replied without looking up and fitting in another word. "But I felt good."

With that the attempted conversation ended. Papai was too engrossed in the crossword puzzle for any chatter. But, for that matter, he seldom is. Papai even talks less than Teddy Beard, the little fellow who won the game for him.

"Here, let me finish that," offered Manager Cohen.

"Go ahead, it's a tough one," replied Al, and with that he folded his arms and relaxed even more, if that was possible. He appeared relaxed on the

mound, too, even when trouble brewed about him. But he had little Teddy on his side and that was the difference.

Teddy won this game for Papai, and here's how: In the first inning he walked, stole second and scored on Jim Delsing's double. In the third he beat out an infield hit and scored with Vince Garcia, who had doubled, on Ron Jackson's triple. In the fifth, Beard put on a daring dash of speed to stretch a hit into a triple, and then scored what turned out to be the winning run when the throw bounced into the Omaha dugout.

So that gave the Indians their third straight victory and an even .500 rating in the standings again. But before it could be accomplished, Papai had to be the master on the mound.

Nothing seemed to bother the veteran, not even the four errors committed behind his back that accounted for two unearned runs. It didn't seem to bother him either when he fell behind on the count to batters. It was just like he was saying: "Here it is, see what you can do with it."

Papai walked only one batter, but seven hits combined with the four Tribe miscues had him in trouble in all but a few innings. The beauty of his pitching, and the importance there to, was the manner in which he mastered the Cardinals in the last two innings while protecting a one-run lead. Two of his three strikeouts came in those rounds.

A cool cucumber, that's Papai.

The competition will get tougher tonight with the Indians facing the Millers in the first of a three-game series. The Millers have won four straight and five of their last six.

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION STANDINGS

	Wen	Lost	Pct.	GB
Wichita	23	10	.697	
St. Paul	21	11	.665	1 1/2
Minneapolis	23	13	.639	1 1/2
INDIANAPOLIS	18	18	.500	6 1/2
Charleston	16	21	.432	9
Omaha	14	19	.424	9
Denver	12	17	.414	9
Louisville	7	25	.219	15 1/2

LAST NIGHT'S RESULTS

Charleston	000	000	101-2	10 0
Minneapolis	004	010	20x-7	12 0
Wiley, Donovan (7), Preske (9) and Griffin; Surkont and Schmidt, LP-Wiley.				
HR-Minneapolis: Cepeda.				
Louisville	000	007	004-11	8 2
St. Paul	201	110	003-	8 10 2
Curtis, Haskins (5), Rudolph (9) and Park; Williams, Wheat (6), Templeton (7)				